

COPILOT-CHEATSHEET.md

Module 00 reference

COURSE	AI Workshop 2.0, Desktop Edition
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YOU NEED	A Mac or PC and a paid Claude plan

When Things Go Wrong - Quick Fixes

Sometimes Claude Code gets stuck, or Copilot doesn't understand what you need. Here's your troubleshooting cheat sheet.

The Nuclear Option: Reset Everything

When Claude Code or Copilot is confused and won't help:

Step 1: Right-Click This File

- Right-click on `COPILOT-CHEATSHEET.md` in your explorer
- Select "Copy Path"

Step 2: Open Copilot Chat

- Press `Cmd+Shift+I` (Mac) or `Ctrl+Shift+I` (Windows)

Step 3: Paste This

I'm having issues with Claude Code / Copilot. Please help me:

1. Read this file: [paste the path you copied]
2. Then help me with my current problem: [describe what's wrong]

If Claude Code has errors or isn't responding, help me clear the session and start fresh.

Common Problems & Quick Fixes

Problem: Claude Code Shows Red Errors

Quick Fix:

1. Look at the error message
2. Right-click the error
3. Copy the full error text
4. Paste it into Copilot and ask: "What does this error mean and how do I fix it?"

Problem: Copilot Won't Understand My Request

Quick Fix:

1. Be more specific
2. Instead of: "Help me with this"
3. Try: "I'm working on [project name]. I need to [specific task]. Here's my current code: [paste code]"
4. Always provide context

Problem: "Claude Code seems stuck"

Quick Fix:

1. Close the Claude Code panel (X button)
2. Restart VS Code completely
3. Open a new Claude Code session
4. Try again

Problem: Extensions Not Working

Quick Fix:

1. Command Palette → Search "Extensions: Show Installed"
2. Look for your extension (should have a green checkmark)

3. If not installed, install it
4. Restart VS Code
5. Try again

Problem: Can't See Rendered Files

Quick Fix:

- Markdown not rendering?
 - Command Palette → "View: Reopen Editor With..."
 - Select "Markdown Preview Enhanced"
- CSV not showing as table?
 - Right-click the file
 - Select "Edit with..." → "Rainbow CSV"
- PDF not opening?
 - Right-click → "Open with..." → "PDF Viewer"

The "Give Me a Hand" Protocol

When you need help from Copilot:

For Claude Code Issues:

My Claude Code is [describe the problem].

Can you:

1. Tell me what's wrong
2. Show me the fix
3. Help me prevent this next time

For File Understanding:

I don't understand this file. Here's the path: [paste path]

Can you:

1. Read it
2. Explain what it does in simple terms
3. Tell me if there are any errors

For "I'm Stuck":

I'm trying to [describe what you want to do].

I've already tried [what you tried].

What should I do next?

Keyboard Shortcuts That Save You

WHAT YOU NEED	MAC	WINDOWS
Open Copilot Chat	Cmd+Shift+I	Ctrl+Shift+I
Command Palette	Cmd+Shift+P	Ctrl+Shift+P
Copy Path	Right-click file	Right-click file
Search Files	Cmd+P	Ctrl+P
Undo	Cmd+Z	Ctrl+Z
Zoom In	Cmd+Plus	Ctrl+Plus
Zoom Out	Cmd+Minus	Ctrl+Minus
Close File	Cmd+W	Ctrl+W
Restart VS Code	Close and reopen	Close and reopen

When to Restart VS Code

✅ DO restart if:

- Extensions won't load
- Copilot won't respond
- Files won't render
- You see strange errors
- Claude Code seems frozen

✅ Steps to restart:

1. Close VS Code completely
2. Wait 5 seconds
3. Reopen VS Code
4. Usually fixes 80% of problems

The "Fresh Start" Prompt

If everything is broken, copy this into Copilot:

```
I need to reset my VS Code setup. Here's what's happening:  
[describe all your problems]
```

```
Can you help me:
```

1. Identify what's broken
2. Fix it step by step
3. Verify everything works
4. Prevent this in the future

```
My VS Code has these extensions installed:
```

- GitHub Copilot
- Claude Code
- Markdown Preview Enhanced
- PDF Viewer
- Rainbow CSV
- VSCode Icons

Pro Tips

Tip 1: Always Include Context

- Don't just say "It doesn't work"
- Say "I'm trying to [task], here's my file [paste], here's the error [paste]"

Tip 2: Use Copy Path for Everything

- Stuck on a file? Right-click → Copy Path → Paste into Copilot
- Copilot can read files directly and help better

Tip 3: Read Error Messages

- They look scary but they're actually helpful
- Copy the whole error into Copilot
- Copilot will explain it in plain English

Tip 4: One Problem at a Time

- Don't ask Copilot to fix 10 things at once
- Describe ONE problem
- Get it fixed
- Move to the next one

Tip 5: Be Specific About Your Goal

- Instead of: "Fix this"
- Try: "I want to [specific goal]. Here's what I tried. Here's the error."

Still Stuck?

Follow this order:

1.  **Read the error message** - Copy it to Copilot
2.  **Restart VS Code** - Close and reopen
3.  **Use Copy Path** - Right-click file → Copilot can read it
4.  **Describe your goal** - Tell Copilot what you're trying to do
5.  **Provide context** - Share the file, error, and what you tried

99% of the time, this solves it.

Remember

You're not alone. Copilot is literally there to help you troubleshoot. The better you describe the problem, the better it can help.

Good description: "I'm trying to open a CSV file but it shows raw text instead of a table. I have Rainbow CSV installed. Here's the file: [path]"

Bad description: "Nothing works"

Copilot can't read minds, but it CAN read files and understand detailed descriptions.

Next Step: When you're ready, go back to the README and continue with personalization tips, or ask Copilot directly: "I'm stuck. Can you help me?"